Local job market in DACH: study for the gig marketplace

(5 demo slides)

Semyon Fast, Oct 2025

General employment state in DACH

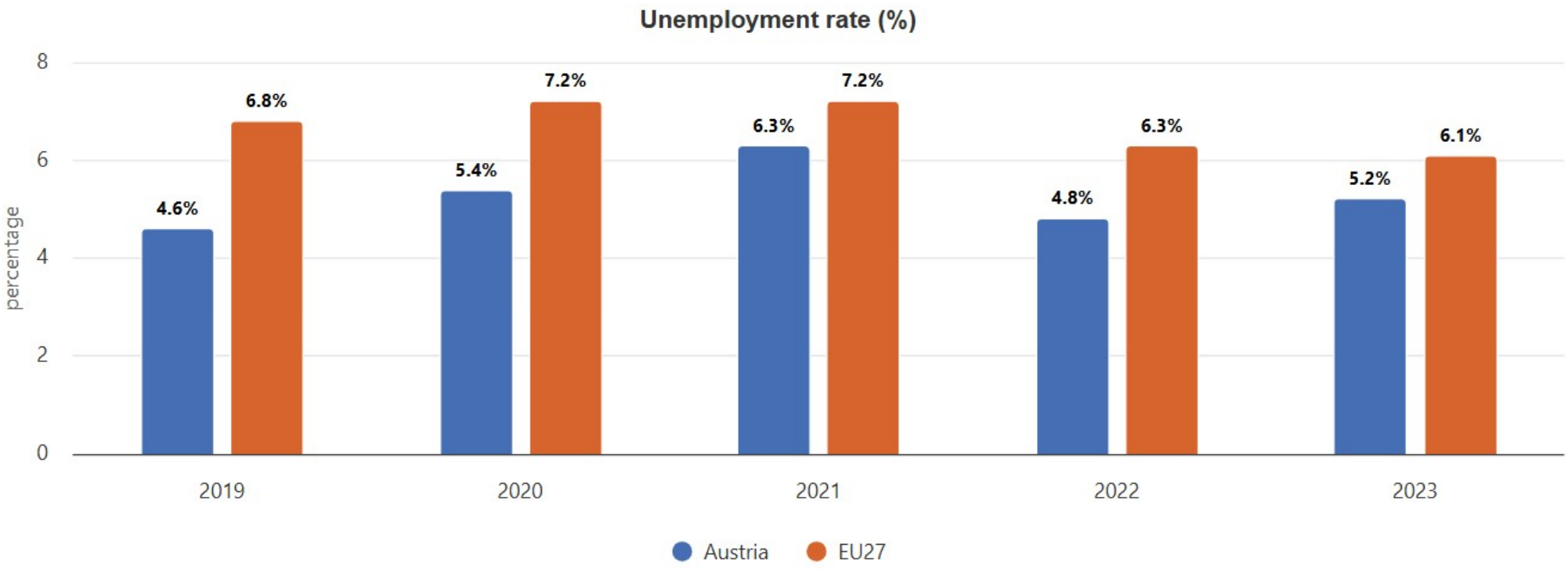
Total addressable market (TAM) for occasional platform/gig works in DACH region is estimated at **€14.5 bln.**

Country	Active workforce, people	Gig workers, % share	Unemployment rate, % share
Austria	4,768,178 (labour force, 2024; World Bank / compiled official stats).	~1–3% of employment via platform/gig platforms (estimates for EU/OECD countries). Some national studies show higher shares for occasional online gig activity but platform-work as main income remains small. OECD, 2019	~7.0% (Sep 2025, national series — recent official releases show unemployment rising in 2025). Trading Economics+1
Germany	43,772,213 (labour force, 2024; World Bank / official compilations).	~3–5% (platform/gig work: OECD/EU evidence shows platform-mediated work is modest overall; survey evidence indicates ~5% of the workforce earn ≥25% of income from platform work in some German surveys). OECD, 2019	~6.3% (mid-2025; Federal Employment Agency releases in 2025 report unemployed & a rate around 6.3–6.4% with recent increases). Bundesagentur fur Arbeit+1
Switzerland	5,152,970 (labour force, 2024; World Bank / national compilations).	Varies — occasional gig work ~15–17% (survey); platform-work as a main source is smaller. Example: a Swiss union / survey reported ~17% of internet users do some gig work occasionally; ~1–5% for main platform workers; up to ~15–17% occasionally.	~2.8% (SECO / official releases, September 2025; Switzerland's unemployment remained low but rose modestly through 2025).

Source: https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/gig-economy-platforms-boon-or-bane_fdb0570b-en.html
https://tradingeconomics.com/austria/labor-force-total-wb-data.html

Obtainable market for Austria is estimated based on the current unemployment rate

Dynamics of unemployment rate in Austria in comparison to other European countries



Note: lfsa_urgan, economically active population (15-64), Statistics | Eurostat (europa.eu)

Taking current Austria unemployment rate at roughly 7% (see the page 2), the number of unemployed can be estimated at 100 k people (taking out the youth and elders).
For the SOM (obtainable market), it yields roughly € 14 mln.

Source: https://eures.europa.eu/living-and-working/labour-market-information/labour-market-information-austria_en

The problems that are mentioned in discussions and can be addressed are “Lack of Specific/In-Demand Roles” and “Seasonal Slowdown”

Problem Name	Description	Number of Occurrences
Difficult Job Market/Economy	The overall market is tough, with high competition, job cuts/firings (even by the state), and a general economic downturn in Austria. Companies are cautious, especially about hiring juniors.	11
High Competition & Candidate Volume	Employers are seeing a "crazy uptick" in applications, making it hard for candidates to stand out. This is worsened by desperate candidates applying to jobs they are only remotely qualified for.	6
Lack of Specific/In-Demand Roles	Specific fields, like telecommunications and 1st level IT Support/Call Center, are described as having poor prospects, becoming obsolete (e.g., due to AI), or being outsourced for lower pay (e.g., to Indian staff).	6
Unrealistic Expectations & Mismatch	A misalignment exists between employee and employer expectations regarding salary and required knowledge/experience. Candidates may also suffer from a CV/profile mismatch with the roles they apply for.	4
Discrimination/Bias	Candidates with a non-German sounding name (e.g., Serb-sounding) or from "ex-communist countries" (especially without C1/C2 German) perceive prejudice in the hiring process, losing out to native speakers/residents.	4
Political/Economic Inaction	The lack of political foresight, competence, or action is blamed for Austria's poor economic performance and its negative impact on the job market and industrial confidence.	4
Difficulty for Experienced Professionals	People with significant experience (3-6 years or 15+ years in the field) are struggling to find work, feeling that employers simply want "the cheapest employee" or a "Junior" salary.	3
Seasonal Slowdown	The summer season (June-September) is noted as an extremely difficult time for job searching in many sectors due to company-wide vacations and scaled-back recruiting efforts.	2

Source: Reddit discussions on job search in Austrian groups

Competitors in Austria

Analysis of frequently mentioned platforms for job search in Austria (Reddit) haven't identified the ones for local tasks, general boards only. Hence the proposed service might be quite differentiated already.

Name	Website	Description	Website Traffic (M visitors)	Features	Monetization Model	Fee (Starting Rate/Model)
karriere.at	www.karriere.at	Austria's largest specialist online career platform targeting professionals and qualified jobs.	~600 k / mo	Tiered Job Ads (Standard, Pro, Boost), Applicant Manager (bewerber.manager), Talent Database Access, Employer Branding solutions, Salary Check Tool.	Premium Job Postings, B2B SaaS Subscriptions (Talent Search, Branding).	A price of €460 for a single ad and quota prices
AMS.at	www.ams.at/organisation	Public Employment Service (PES) mandated to prevent and eradicate unemployment. Public utility role.	~1.5 mln / mo	Job Search, Unemployment Benefits Application, eAMS-Konto, Qualification/Training programs (co-funding), Labor Market Data, Algorithmic Profiling.	Publicly Funded (Labour Market Funding Budget).	Free of charge for job seekers and enterprises.
willhaben.at	www.willhaben.at/iad	General Austrian classifieds platform (7th most visited site) with a high-volume jobs vertical.	~3.5 mln / mo	Classified Job Listings, Sector Search, Company Pages, Basic search filters (location, profession, hours).	Classified Listing Fees (Pay-per-Post or package based).	Fee-based. Sale of job advertisements , often in the form of quotas and packages (similar to karriere.at).

Source: Reddit for intial candidates list, author's research and LLM review for the table composition
https://www.reddit.com/r/Austria/comments/1g6cehv/comment/lshrsd1/?tl=de